

Letter of Professional Recommendation

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May 26, 2026

Re: Professional recommendation for Matt Waite — AI and Cloud Architect

To the Hiring Manager:

It is a genuine pleasure to recommend Matt Waite for the AI and Cloud Architect role with the State of Indiana. I worked alongside Matt during my tenure with the State, where we collaborated on enterprise cloud and platform initiatives that touched architecture review, governance, identity, and day-to-day operational delivery. The recommendation that follows is based on direct, sustained experience working with him on real problems under real constraints — not on title, tenure, or résumé summary.

What stands out most about Matt is how little instruction he requires to produce high-quality, defensible work. On more than one occasion I watched him receive an ambiguous problem statement — the kind that arrives with competing stakeholder priorities, partial documentation, and an aggressive timeline — and quietly turn it into a structured, well-reasoned deliverable that the rest of the team could actually build against. He does not wait to be told what the next step is. He identifies it, validates it, and moves. That trait alone is rare in any environment; in a public-sector technology organization, where ownership gaps are common and the cost of indecision is measured in months, it is genuinely valuable.

Matt is also one of the most disciplined self-directed learners I have worked with. When the work in front of us required a capability he did not yet have — a new cloud service, an unfamiliar identity pattern, a governance framework neither of us had previously applied — his default response was to go learn it, in depth, and then come back with a practical, opinionated point of view on how it should be applied to the situation at hand. He does not learn for the sake of credentials or surface familiarity; he learns so he can make the right call and explain why. The result is that he can be trusted with greenfield problems and emerging-technology decisions, including the kind of generative-AI and multi-cloud architecture-review work this position is built around, without the organization having to absorb the risk of a long ramp-up.

Three additional qualities are worth noting because they map directly to the responsibilities of this role:

- **Provider-neutral, evidence-first reasoning.** Matt evaluates technology on operational reality rather than vendor narrative. He is comfortable comparing options across major cloud providers on their actual merits — availability in regulated environments, parity lag, identity and access posture, compliance footprint — and stating clearly when the public evidence does not yet support a firm recommendation. That intellectual honesty is exactly what an architecture-review function needs.
- **Governance instincts without bureaucratic drag.** He understands that standards, tagging, naming, logging, infrastructure-as-code, and gate reviews exist to make the enterprise faster and safer over time, not to slow individual teams down. He applies them in that spirit, and he is able to explain the "why" to engineers and to leadership in language each audience actually uses.
- **Collaborative under pressure.** Matt works well with security, privacy, identity, data, and operations partners. He listens before he prescribes, he gives credit generously, and he is willing to change his position when better information shows up. He is also direct and respectful when he disagrees, which is the combination you want in someone who will be making go/no-go calls on production transitions.

In short: Matt is a self-starter who consistently delivers thoughtful, technically sound work with minimal oversight, learns aggressively and practically, and partners well across the kinds of cross-functional teams this role depends on. I would hire him again without hesitation, and I believe the State of Indiana would be well served by adding him to this team.

I am happy to speak further about my experience working with Matt. Please feel free to contact me using the information at the top of this letter.

Sincerely,

Ryan McVey